

Knut Niemann

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Tübingen	10/2019 – 12/2023
Overall grade: <i>summa cum laude</i>	
M.Sc. in Economics and Finance, University of Tübingen	10/2017 – 09/2019
B.Sc. in Economics and Business Administration, University of Tübingen	10/2012 – 09/2016

Fields of Interest

Applied microeconomics, international economics, expectation formation, political economy

Academic Positions

Postdoctoral Researcher, Prof. Dr. Anna Gumpert, University of Tübingen	10/2023 – present
Doctoral Student, Prof. Dr. Gernot Müller, University of Tübingen	10/2019 – 06/2023

External Experience and Stays Abroad

Visiting Researcher, Danmarks Nationalbank, Copenhagen	04/2026 – 05/2026
Intern Directorate General Economics, Bundesbank, Frankfurt	05/2022 – 09/2022
Visiting Student, University of Massachusetts, Amherst	09/2014 – 05/2015

Job Market Paper

Political Distance and International Trade, [latest version](#)

Single-authored

Extending the historical and geographic scope of existing evidence, I document the relevance of political distance for trade across 166 countries over 55 years (1966–2020), beyond recent fragmentation episodes. While existing literature allows for both demand shifts and trade costs, the overall empirical evidence favours the trade-cost interpretation, informing the paper's welfare counterfactuals.

An earlier version was discussed in the IRC report [“The EU's Open Strategic Autonomy from a central banking perspective.”](#)

Publications

Firm expectations about production and prices: Facts, determinants, and effects, [pub. version](#) with [Benjamin Born](#), [Zeno Enders](#), and [Gernot Müller](#), in: Rüdiger Bachmann, Giorgio Topa, and Wilbert van der Klaauw, eds., **Handbook of Economic Expectations**, Elsevier, 2023, pp. 355–383.

Working Papers

Firm Expectations and News: Micro v Macro, [latest version](#)

with [Benjamin Born](#), [Zeno Enders](#), [Manuel Menkhoff](#), and [Gernot Müller](#)

Revise & Resubmit at **American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics**

German and Italian firm surveys show overreaction to firm-specific news and underreaction to aggregate news. I developed and implemented the empirical framework for the Italian SIGE data and prepared the ifo data.

Political Shocks, Interstate Migration, and Geographic Polarization, [latest version](#)

with [Jonas Adolph](#)

Using close US gubernatorial elections and county-to-county migration data, we document increased outmigration from losing-party counties and sorting towards politically aligned destinations. I developed the research question and led data preparation and the election-based empirical analysis; my co-author contributed the migration model and gravity estimates.

Work in progress

Tariffs and Danish Exports: Insights from Three Decades of Microdata,

with [Henrik Yde Andersen](#), [Mathias Klein](#), and [Thomas Krause](#)

We study how Danish exporters adjust export unit values and destination diversification in response to tariffs. I lead the empirical design in discussion with co-authors and implement the analysis.

Presentations

- 2026 EEA-ESEM Meeting (Dublin);
European Trade Study Group (ETSG; University of Exeter);
XXVII Conference on International Economics (Ciudad Real; 2 papers); Danmarks
Nationalbank
- 2025 RWTH Aachen; RSIT Brown Bag (Tübingen); Macro Brown Bag (Tübingen)
- 2024 Tübingen-Hohenheim-Economics Workshop (Discussant); Macro Brown Bag (Tübingen)
- 2023 Macro Brown Bag (Tübingen, twice)
- 2022 Bundesbank internal seminars; BoE-BdF-BBk-ECB Global Economy Meeting (Eltham);
Dynare Conference (Lancaster); DFG Priority Programme 1859 online seminar

Grants and Awards

2026 Conference travel support, Friedrich-List-Stiftung (EUR 1,058.94), for the XXVII Conference on International Economics, Ciudad Real, Spain

Teaching Experience

Master Thesis Supervision (8 submitted)	2024–2026
Master Seminar (co-taught) 2025: 1.2 / 1.1	2024–2026
Advanced International Trade Theory (Lecture + Tutorial Coordination, Master) 2025: 1.6 / 1.2; 2026: 1.7 / 1.5	2024–2026
Firms in the Global Economy (Lecture + Tutorial, Bachelor) 2024: 2.0 / 1.3; 2025: 1.6 / 1.1	2023–2026
Bachelor Tutorials Macroeconomics I (3x), Exploratory Data Analysis, Probability and Risk, Quantitative Methods, Intermediate Microeconomics	2016–2022

Evaluations are course / instructor averages on a 1–5 scale (1 = very good, 5=insufficient).

Academic Service and Teaching Coordination

Full responsibility for organising and coordinating Bachelor's and Master's courses and seminars during my postdoc.

Coordinated up to eight research assistants in introductory macroeconomics and developed on-line tutorials and exams for around 500 students during the pandemic.

Participated in recruitment, interviews and admissions assessment for Tübingen's Economics Master's programmes.

Refereeing

Economics Letters, European Economic Review

Additional Information

Languages: German (native), English (fluent), Italian (basic), French (basic)

Research software: Stata, MATLAB, R, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Service: Board Member and Treasurer of SSC Tübingen e.V. since 2017 (responsible for the finances of a multi-sport club with more than 1,000 members)

References

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